

- Make certain that blog entries, quotations, headlines, photos and all other content do not misrepresent. They should not oversimplify or highlight incidents out of context.

(“Out of context” is key here. Often, you see something someone said, and latch on to that one phrase—don’t.)

- Never distort the content of photos without disclosing what has been changed. Image enhancement is only acceptable for technical clarity. Label montages and photo illustrations.

(Not following this rule is pretty much the same thing as lying, and since a picture is worth a thousand words...)

- Never publish information they know is inaccurate – and if publishing questionable information, make it clear it’s in doubt.
- Distinguish between advocacy, commentary and factual information. Even advocacy writing and commentary should not misrepresent fact or context.
- Distinguish factual information and commentary from advertising and shun hybrids that blur the lines between the two.
- Show compassion for those who may be affected adversely by blog content. Use special sensitivity when dealing with children and inexperienced sources or subjects.
- Be sensitive when seeking or using interviews or photographs of those affected by tragedy or grief.
- Recognise that gathering and reporting information may cause harm or discomfort. Pursuit of information is not a license for arrogance.

(These three tenets apply to journalism as well.)

- Show good taste. Avoid pandering to lurid curiosity.
(Don’t be a tabloid. At least, try not to be; even if you maintain a *gossip* blog, don’t over-sensationalise things)